Week 2 Update

Michael Fang

March 2026

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Weekly progress meeting with Professor Torquato.
Main topics:

- Recap of last week (metallic means, $\alpha = 3$)
- URL validation: confirmed $\bar{\Lambda} = (1 + a^2)/6$ to $< 0.3\%$
- Stealthy patterns: $\bar{\Lambda} \approx 1/(\pi^2 \chi)$, $\alpha \to \infty$
- Bombieri-Taylor cubic: $\alpha = 1.545$, $\bar{\Lambda} = 0.377$
- Updated ranking

Recap

Previously:

- Variance code validated (Poisson benchmark, 1.1% error)
- Three metallic-mean chains: Fibonacci, Silver, Bronze
- All gave $\alpha = 3$ as expected

Pattern	α (measured)	α (expected)	$\bar{\Lambda}$
Fibonacci	3.05	3	0.200
Silver	2.99	3	0.250
Bronze	2.99	3	0.282

Since then: Validated URL and stealthy patterns; found a quasicrystal in the $1 < \alpha < 2$ gap.

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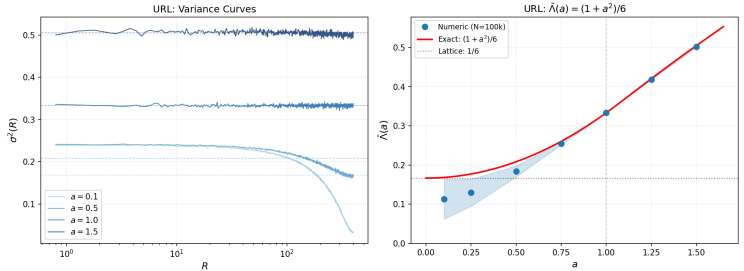
Since then: Validated URL and stealthy patterns; found a quasicrystal in the $1 < \alpha < 2$ gap.

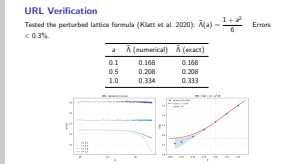
The metallic means all give $\alpha = 3$ because of the 2x2 matrix constraint: $|\lambda_2| = 1/|\lambda_1|$.
Since then, I've worked on more patterns including URL, stealthy, and Bombieri-Taylor.

URL Verification

Tested the perturbed lattice formula (Klatt et al. 2020): $\bar{\Lambda}(a) = \dfrac{1+a^2}{6}$ Errors $< 0.3\%$.

a	$\bar{\Lambda}$ (numerical)	$\bar{\Lambda}$ (exact)
0.1	0.168	0.168
0.5	0.208	0.208
1.0	0.334	0.333





URL = uncorrelated random lattice (independent displacements on integer lattice).
Exact formula from Klatt et al. (2020): $\bar{\Lambda}(a) = (1+a^2)/6$. Recovers lattice value 1/6 at $a = 0$; equals 1/3 at $a = 1$. Always $\alpha = 2$ regardless of a. Good validation because we have an exact analytical target.

$a = 1.0$ is the cloaked case: the displacement cell exactly tiles the unit cell so the Bragg peaks vanish entirely from $S(k)$. $\bar{\Lambda}$ still increases monotonically even as the long-range order disappears from two-point statistics.

Stealthy Patterns

Analyzed stealthy configurations provided by Sam.

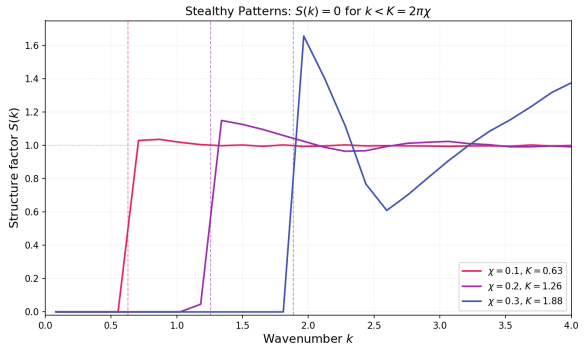
Idea: Force $S(k) = 0$ for all $|k| < K^*$, not just at $k = 0$.

Results ($N = 2{,}000$, $\sim$4000 configs each):

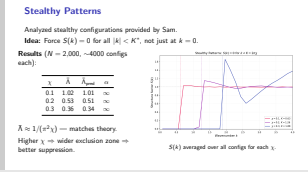
χ	$\bar{\Lambda}$	$\bar{\Lambda}_{\text{pred}}$	α
0.1	1.02	1.01	∞
0.2	0.53	0.51	∞
0.3	0.36	0.34	∞

$\bar{\Lambda} \approx 1/(\pi^2\chi)$ — matches theory.

Higher $\chi \Rightarrow$ wider exclusion zone $\Rightarrow$ better suppression.



$S(k)$ averaged over all configs for each χ.



Data from Sam (4000 configs per χ, CCO format).
χ controls the size of the exclusion region: $K = 2\pi\chi$.
Theory predicts $\bar{\Lambda} \approx 1/(\pi^2\chi)$.
We can see the exclusion zone clearly widen as as χ increases, and $S(k)$ rises sharply at K^* before approaching 1 at large k.
$\alpha \to \infty$: $S(k) = 0$ over a finite exclusion zone, not a power law. This is confirmed by exponential spreadability decay.

Filling the $1 < \alpha < 2$ Gap

There was a gap in the α coverage:

α	Class	Examples
∞	I	Lattice, Stealthy
3	I	Fibonacci, Silver, Bronze
2	I	URL
$1 < \alpha < 2$	I	No quasicrystal
1	II	Period-Doubling
< 1	III	0222

The issue: all 2×2 metallic-mean matrices give $\alpha = 3$ because $|\lambda_2| = 1/|\lambda_1|$.
Solution: the Bombieri-Taylor cubic substitution (1986 paper, p. C3-21).

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Solution: the Bombieri-Taylor cubic substitution (1986 paper, p. C3-21).

Lattice and stealthy both have $\alpha = \infty$ (S(k) = 0 over a finite region, not just at k=0).
The metallic-mean 2x2 constraint: $\det(M) = \pm1$ forces $|\lambda_2| = 1/|\lambda_1|$, always giving $\alpha = 3$.
The gap at $1 < \alpha < 2$ is filled by the Bombieri-Taylor cubic substitution on the next slide.

Bombieri-Taylor Cubic Substitution

From the 1986 paper (p. C3-21):

Three-letter alphabet:

$$a \to aac,\ b \to ac,\ c \to b$$

Matrix:

$$M = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

Eigenvalues: $\theta_1 = 2.247$, $|\lambda_2| = 0.802$

Predicted:

$$\alpha = 1 - \frac{2\ln(0.802)}{\ln(2.247)} = \mathbf{1.545}$$

Implementation:

- Extended code for 3-letter alphabets
- Generated 9.5 million points
- Computed variance and $\bar{\Lambda}$

Result: $\bar{\Lambda} = 0.377$, Class I confirmed.

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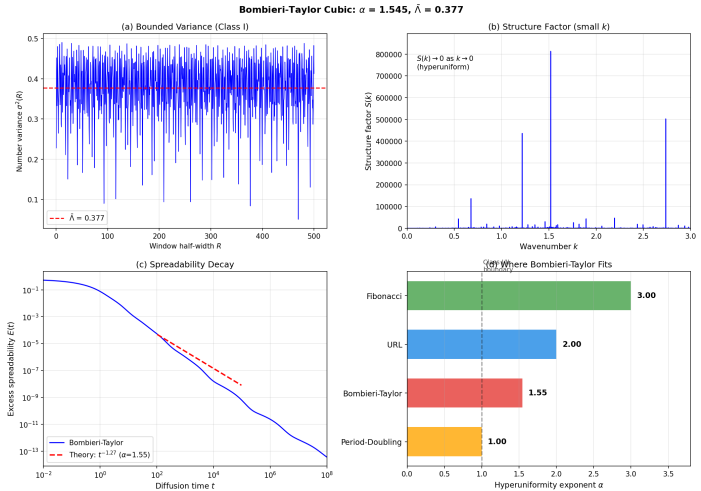
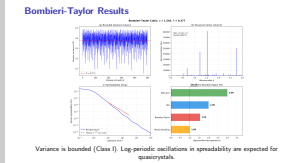
Key: $|\lambda_2| = 0.802 \neq 1/\theta_1 = 0.445$.
The 3x3 matrix breaks the constraint.
θ_1 is a Pisot number (conjugates all < 1).

Bombieri-Taylor Results



Variance is bounded (Class I). Log-periodic oscillations in spreadability are expected for quasicrystals.



Panel (a): Bounded variance confirms Class I. Oscillates between 0.05–0.49, mean = 0.377.
Panel (b): Structure factor at small k. Shows $S(k) \to 0$ as $k \to 0$ (hyperuniform). Bragg peaks are characteristic of quasicrystals.
Panel (c): Spreadability decay. The log-periodic oscillations make power-law fitting unreliable for quasicrystals. The eigenvalue formula is exact; spreadability fit is not.
Panel (d): Shows Bombieri-Taylor fills the gap between Period-Doubling ($\alpha = 1$) and URL ($\alpha = 2$). Stealthy patterns have $\alpha \to \infty$ and do not appear on this axis.
Confidence: $\alpha = 1.545$ is exact (analytical from eigenvalues). $\bar{\Lambda} = 0.377$ is numerical average of bounded variance.

Updated Ranking

Here's where everything stands now:

Pattern	**Class**	α	$\bar{\Lambda}$
Lattice	I	∞	0.167
URL ($a = 0.1$)	I	2.0	0.168
Fibonacci	I	3.0	0.200
Silver	I	3.0	0.250
Bronze	I	3.0	0.282
URL ($a = 1.0$)	I	2.0	0.333
Stealthy ($\chi = 0.3$)	I	∞	0.358
Bombieri-Taylor	**I**	**1.545**	**0.377**
Period-Doubling	II	1.0	diverges
0222	III	0.64	diverges

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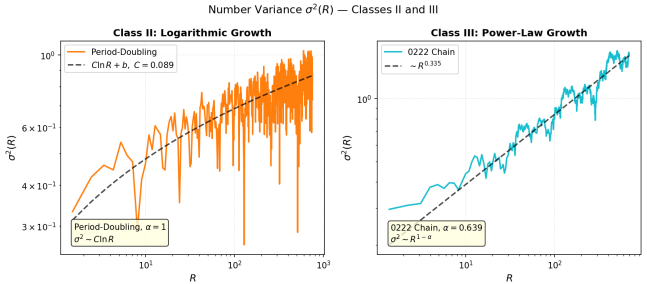
Table shows a selected subset of the 26 patterns analyzed, sorted by $\bar{\Lambda}$ within Class I.
Lattice and Stealthy both have $\alpha = \infty$; they are ranked by $\bar{\Lambda}$ (0.167 vs. 0.358).
URL ($a = 0.1$, $\bar{\Lambda} = 0.168$) sits just above the lattice minimum, illustrating that α and $\bar{\Lambda}$ are independent metrics.
Bombieri-Taylor ($\alpha = 1.545$) is the only Class I quasicrystal with $1 < \alpha < 2$.

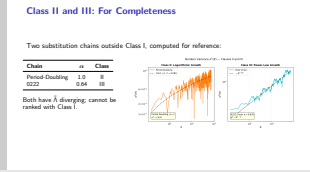
Class II and III: For Completeness

Two substitution chains outside Class I, computed for reference:

Chain	α	Class
Period-Doubling	1.0	II
0222	0.64	III

Both have $\bar{\Lambda}$ diverging; cannot be ranked with Class I.





Period-Doubling: $|\lambda_2| = 1$ exactly, so $\alpha = 1$ and variance grows logarithmically. 0222: $|\lambda_2| = \sqrt{5} - 1 > 1$, so $\alpha = 0.64$ and variance grows as $R^{0.36}$.

Both are known results from Oguz et al. (2019). Computed here to verify the full three-class picture numerically.

Summary

Since our last meeting:

- Verified URL formula to $< 0.3\%$
- Analyzed stealthy data ($\bar{\Lambda} \approx 1/(\pi^2\chi)$, $\alpha \to \infty$)
- Implemented Bombieri-Taylor cubic ($\alpha = 1.545$, fills $1 < \alpha < 2$ gap)
- Confirmed Class II and III numerically (Period-Doubling, 0222)

Possible next steps:

- Other cubic/quartic substitutions
- 2D generalizations?

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References

- Torquato & Stillinger (2003), Phys. Rev. E 68, 041113
- Bombieri & Taylor (1986), J. Physique Colloques 47, C3-19
- Oğuz et al. (2017), Phys. Rev. B 95, 054119
- Klatt, Kim & Torquato (2020), Phys. Rev. E 101, 032118
- Torquato (2021), Phys. Rev. E 104, 054102

References

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